

Prompt Like a Producer

A 45-minute AI literacy lesson: students learn that the quality of an AI's answer depends on the quality of the direction it gets — just like a track depends on its producer.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Prompt Remix Studio worksheet (1 per student)	Optional — works fully unplugged	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

- Students can explain why the same AI gives different quality answers to different prompts.
- Students can apply the **P.R.O. framework** (Purpose, Requirements, Output) to write a clear prompt.
- Students can evaluate an AI response for accuracy and identify when to double-check it.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

ISTE 1.5.c

ISTE 1.6.a

ISTE 1.1.c

CCSS ELA W.6.4

Full standards text in the Teacher Guide.

WARM-UP — "MAKE IT GOOD" (5 MIN)

Ask a volunteer to stand up. Tell them: "*Sing something. Make it good.*" Let the awkwardness land, then ask the class: **why was that hard?** (No genre, no mood, no song, no direction.)

Bridge: "In a studio, the producer's whole job is direction — genre, tempo, mood, reference tracks. Today you learn to be the producer. The AI is the artist in the booth waiting for direction."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THE P.R.O. FRAMEWORK (10 MIN)

Write on the board and unpack with the class:

P — Purpose. What do you actually want, and who is it for? *"Explain photosynthesis to a 6th grader"* beats *"explain photosynthesis."*

R — Requirements. The creative direction: length, tone, format, what to include, what to avoid. This is the producer's genre-and-tempo call.

O — Output. What should the final product look like? A list? A paragraph? A table? A song with a hook?

Model it live (on the board or with a projected AI tool):

WEAK PROMPT	P.R.O. PROMPT
"help with my history essay"	"I'm writing a 5-paragraph essay for 7th grade history on why the printing press mattered. Give me 3 possible thesis statements and 2 pieces of evidence for each, as a bullet list. Don't write the essay for me."

Say it plainly: "Notice the last line — *don't write the essay for me*. Using AI to think WITH you is a skill. Turning in its work as yours is just letting somebody else rap over your name."

ACTIVITY — PROMPT REMIX STUDIO (20 MIN)

- Solo (8 min):** Students remix the three weak prompts on the worksheet using P.R.O.
- Pairs (7 min):** Swap sheets. Partner scores each remix with the Producer's Checklist (on worksheet).
- Showcase (5 min):** 2–3 students read a "before and after." If devices are available, run the best remix live and critique the output together.

EXIT TICKET (5 MIN)

Bottom of worksheet: students write one P.R.O. prompt they could actually use this week for another class, and name **one thing they'd double-check** in the AI's answer before trusting it.

DIFFERENTIATION

- Support:** Provide the P.R.O. sentence starters (Teacher Guide, p.2).
- Extension:** Students write a prompt that produces a BAD answer on purpose, then explain why it fails.
- No-device classrooms:** The teacher plays "the AI" and responds literally to weak prompts — comedy included.